

The week ahead

Naivasha, Kenya | 12–16 October 2026 | Based on the revised workshop agenda

Day 1 · Monday, 12 October 2026

Connect & understand

08:00–09:00 Registration

09:00–10:30 · Session 1

Opening ceremony

Welcome, shared purpose, the week ahead and official photograph. Any handbook launch is subject to confirmation.

10:30–11:00 Coffee break

11:00–12:30 · Session 2

Our two sectors: common ground and shared goals

Mixed groups build the Commonality Market, write shared goals and adopt the Return Rule.

12:30–14:00 Lunch

14:00–15:15 · Session 3

Social dialogue in the public services

Name the form of dialogue, clarify who sits at the table and agree how we will work.

15:15–15:45 Coffee break

15:45–17:00 · Session 4

Understanding conflict and how it develops into a dispute

Map the Joe and Frank case; identify aggravators, moderators and earlier intervention.

Session times are East Africa Time (UTC+3).

Day 2 · Tuesday, 13 October 2026

Choose & communicate

09:00–10:30 · Session 1

Approaches to managing and resolving conflict

Compare power, rights, avoidance and consensus using six paired scenarios.

10:30–11:00 Coffee break

11:00–12:30 · Session 2

Kenya's legal and institutional framework

Connect rights, recognition, SRC advice, funding and registration to preparation and implementation.

12:30–14:00 Lunch

14:00–15:15 · Session 3

Positional and needs-based bargaining

Compare approaches issue by issue, assess five outcomes and distinguish compromise from meeting interests.

15:15–15:45 Coffee break

15:45–17:00 · Session 4

Constructive communication at the table

Practise listening, paraphrasing, open questions and reframing while respecting your mandate.

Session times are East Africa Time (UTC+3).

Day 3 · Wednesday, 14 October 2026

Prepare & practise

09:00–10:30 · Session 1

The negotiator's dilemma and generating options

Balance creating and claiming value; generate options before evaluating them.

10:30–11:00 Coffee break

11:00–12:30 · Session 2

Alternatives, preparation and mandating

Build a BATNA and mandate. Job Grading teams form and receive their briefs before lunch.

12:30–14:00 Lunch

14:00–15:15 · Session 3

Experiencing the negotiation process

Job Grading teams negotiate live at 14:00, record outcomes and debrief.

15:15–15:45 Coffee break

15:45–17:00 · Session 4

Extracting Needs and reflecting on practice

Run two paired Extracting Needs rounds, then set two improvement priorities.

Session times are East Africa Time (UTC+3).

Day 4 · Thursday, 15 October 2026

Cost & negotiate

09:00–10:30 · Session 1

The economics of bargaining with government — Part 1

Test comparability, cost of living and ability to pay; agree the measure and denominator.

10:30–11:00 Coffee break

11:00–12:30 · Session 2

Building an evidence-based claim and response — Part 2

Prepare a costed claim or funded response. Simulation roles and briefs are allocated before afternoon preparation.

12:30–14:00 Lunch

14:00–15:15 · Session 3

Preparing for the sector simulations

Prepare three issues, authority limits, trade-offs and a difficult-moments plan.

15:15–15:45 Coffee break

15:45–17:00 · Session 4

Sector negotiation simulations

Parallel public health and higher education negotiations: five-minute huddle, 50-minute negotiation and written record.

Session times are East Africa Time (UTC+3).

Day 5 · Friday, 16 October 2026

Commit & carry forward

09:00–10:30 · Session 1

Sharing across sectors and closing a negotiation

Report back across sectors, compare experience and practise a precise closing sequence.

10:30–11:00 Coffee break

11:00–12:30 · Session 2

Way forward, evaluation and closing ceremony

Write sector action points, complete evaluation and close by 12:30.

Friday closes at 12:30.